



America 250: The Signers Quiz Deck

40 verified Q&A cards on the 56 men who signed the Declaration

\$6.00 · INSTANT DIGITAL DOWNLOAD

Liberty Line — patriotism & America 250

Contents

1. How It Works
2. Suit I — The Basics
3. Suit II — The Record-Holders
4. Suit III — Myth vs. Fact
5. Suit IV — The Human Stories
6. Suit V — The Words & the Artifacts
7. Bonus: Read-Aloud Master List

America 250: The Signers Quiz Deck

Product: America 250 — The Signers Quiz Deck **Format:** Instant-download printable PDF (print-and-cut cards, 2-sided: question front / answer back) + a play-anywhere read-aloud list. **Price:** \$6 (digital, instant download) **Line:** Founding Fathers (Liberty Line, patriotism & America-250) **Buyer:** the proud, patriotic American 45-70 who buys the July-4 cookout, wants ONE true thing to retell, and loves being the person at the table who knows the real story. Same buyer as the Founding Fathers Pack (\$8), the Founding Documents Reader (\$12), and the "Second of July" tee.

> dated sources (see .sources.md). Legends/anecdotes are LABELED as legends, never presented as fact — > this honest-provenance framing is a FEATURE for the history-buff buyer. Route through quill-critic > (product/copy, 3x) before anything leaves the company. No third-party marks; public-domain facts only.

HOW IT WORKS

40 question-and-answer cards about the 56 men who signed the Declaration of Independence. Print double-sided (question on front, answer on back), cut, and play: cookout trivia, a road-trip game, a classroom warm-up, or a solo "how many can you get" for the 250th. Cards are grouped in five suits so you can play a quick round or the full deck. Answers include the source-verified fact AND, where a popular story is only a legend, a clear "LEGEND" flag so you never repeat a myth as truth.

The one rule that makes this deck different: if it's a legend, we SAY it's a legend. The good stories are still here — they're just labeled honestly. That's what makes it safe to repeat at the table.

SUIT I — THE BASICS (the facts everyone gets wrong)

CARD 1

How many men signed the Declaration of Independence?

56. They represented the 13 states (then colonies turned states).

CARD 2

Did all 56 sign it on July 4, 1776?

No. Congress *adopted* the Declaration on July 4. Most delegates signed the formal engrossed

CARD 3

What did Congress actually do on July 2, 1776?

Voted for independence — approving the Lee Resolution 12 colonies to 0 (New York abstained, then

CARD 4

Who signed first, and why is his signature the biggest?

John Hancock, President of the Continental Congress. As presiding officer he signed first and his

CARD 5

TRUE or LEGEND — Hancock signed big "so King George could read it without his spectacles."

LEGEND. It's a beloved story but apocryphal — it appeared years later (the earliest version named

CARD 6

When was the Declaration first read aloud to the public?

July 8, 1776, in the yard of the Pennsylvania State House (Independence Hall) in Philadelphia.

CARD 7

Which two future U.S. Presidents signed the Declaration?

John Adams (2nd President) and **Thomas Jefferson** (3rd President). Jefferson was its principal author.

CARD 8

How many states were represented among the signers?

13. New York's delegates signed after their colony's vote came through, so all thirteen are represented.

SUIT II — THE RECORD-HOLDERS (youngest, oldest, only, last)

CARD 9

Who was the YOUNGEST signer?

Edward Rutledge of South Carolina — about **26** years old.

CARD 10

Who was the OLDEST signer?

Benjamin Franklin of Pennsylvania — **70** years old.

CARD 11

Who was the LAST surviving signer?

Charles Carroll of Carrollton of Maryland, who died **November 14, 1832** — outliving every other

CARD 12

Who was the only Roman Catholic signer?

Charles Carroll of Carrollton — also the wealthiest of the signers.

CARD 13

Who was the only active clergyman to sign?

John Witherspoon of New Jersey — a Presbyterian minister and president of the College of New Jersey

CARD 14

Which signer is the only person to sign ALL FOUR of America's great founding papers?

Roger Sherman of Connecticut — the Continental Association, the Declaration of Independence, the

CARD 15

Whose signature is one of the rarest and most valuable autographs in America?

Button Gwinnett of Georgia. He died young — killed in a **duel in 1777** — so very few documents

CARD 16

Which signer's name gave us a word still used in politics today?

Elbridge Gerry of Massachusetts. As governor decades later (1812) he approved an oddly shaped voting

CARD 17

The famous painting of the "signing" — what moment does it really show?

John Trumbull's painting shows the drafting committee **presenting the draft to Congress (about June 28,

SUIT III — MYTH vs. FACT (label the legend)

CARD 18

TRUE or LEGEND — Franklin said "We must all hang together, or... we shall all hang separately."

LEGEND. A great line, but there's no contemporary record of him saying it; it was attributed to

CARD 19

TRUE or LEGEND — every signer was hunted down, tortured, and died penniless for signing.

LEGEND (heavily embellished). A widely shared essay ("The Price They Paid," popularized by Paul Harvey)

CARD 20

TRUE or LEGEND — Stephen Hopkins said "My hand trembles, but my heart does not."

LEGEND / TRADITION. Hopkins of Rhode Island (about 69) did have a palsy that shook his hand, and the

CARD 21

TRUE or LEGEND — the Liberty Bell rang to announce the signing on July 4, 1776.

LEGEND. That story comes from an 1847 fictional tale. The bell wasn't even called the "Liberty Bell"

CARD 22

Did the man who wrote out the beautiful parchment sign it?

No. The engrossed parchment is generally **attributed to Timothy Matlack**, an assistant to the

CARD 23

Was there a passage in Jefferson's draft that Congress removed?

Yes. Congress edited Jefferson's draft and struck a passage condemning the slave trade, among other

CARD 24

Did any member of the drafting Committee of Five NOT sign?

Yes — Robert R. Livingston of New York. He was one of the five who drafted it but was recalled and

SUIT IV — THE HUMAN STORIES (verified)

CARD 25

Which two signers were brothers?

Richard Henry Lee and Francis Lightfoot

Lee of Virginia — both signed. (Richard Henry Lee introduced

CARD 26

Which signer rode through the night to break his state's tie vote?

Caesar Rodney of Delaware — he rode about 80 miles overnight to Philadelphia (arriving July 2) to cast

CARD 27

Which signer was lost at sea?

Thomas Lynch Jr. of South Carolina. In 1779 he and his wife sailed for his health and were never seen

CARD 28

Which signer was "the Financier of the Revolution" and later landed in debtors' prison?

Robert Morris of Pennsylvania. He helped fund the war effort, but land speculation ruined him and he

CARD 29

Which signer was a famous physician and reformer?

Benjamin Rush of Pennsylvania — a leading doctor of the era, and a friend who later helped reconcile

CARD 30

Who were Georgia's three signers?

Button Gwinnett, Lyman Hall, and George Walton.

CARD 31

Which New Hampshire signer added his name months later?

Matthew Thornton — he joined Congress in the fall and signed in **November 1776**, after the main

CARD 32

Which signer is (by tradition) said to have watched each man's face as he signed?

William Ellery of Rhode Island — by his own later account he positioned himself to observe each

CARD 33

John Hart of New Jersey — what happened to his farm during the war?

His property WAS raided and damaged when British and Hessian forces moved through New Jersey, and he had

CARD 34

How old, on average, were the signers?

Their **early-to-mid 40s** on average — but the range was wide, from Rutledge at 26 to Franklin at 70.

SUIT V — THE WORDS & THE ARTIFACTS

CARD 35

What did the signers pledge in the Declaration's final sentence?

"...we mutually pledge to each other our **Lives, our Fortunes and our sacred Honor.**"

CARD 36

What went out to the world FIRST — the signed parchment, or a printed version?

A printed version. The night of July 4, printer **John Dunlap** produced about 200 printed copies (the

CARD 37

How many Dunlap broadsides — the first printing — are known to survive today?

26 known copies. One was famously found behind a **\$4 flea-market painting** in 1989 and later sold for

CARD 38

What silver object on the signing table still survives at Independence Hall?

The **Syng inkstand** — a silver inkstand (made by Philip Syng) used by the delegates; it is preserved at

CARD 39

Franklin also holds a rare signing distinction across the founding era — what?

He is commonly cited as the only person to sign the ****Declaration of Independence, the Treaty of Alliance**

CARD 40

Why does the July 4 date on the document confuse people about the signing?

Because the parchment is headed "In Congress, July 4, 1776" — the **ADOPTION** date — even though most

Bonus: Read-Aloud Master List

— READ-ALOUD MASTER LIST (quiz-master sheet)

How to play aloud: read the question, take answers, then read the bolded answer. For LEGEND cards, ask "True or Legend?" and award the point only for "Legend." Quick round = one suit (8-9 cards); full game = all 40. Suggested scoring: 1 point per correct card; Card 35 must be word-perfect for 2 points.

Suit I — The Basics

1. How many signed? — **56**
2. All signed July 4? — **No — adopted July 4; most signed Aug 2, 1776**
3. What happened July 2, 1776? — **Congress voted for independence (Lee Resolution, 12-0, NY abstaining)**
4. First and biggest signature? — **John Hancock, President of Congress**
5. Hancock signed big "for King George's spectacles"? — **LEGEND**
6. First public reading? — **July 8, 1776, Philadelphia (State House yard)**
7. Two future Presidents who signed? — **John Adams & Thomas Jefferson**
8. States represented? — **13**

Suit II — The Record-Holders

1. Youngest signer? — **Edward Rutledge (SC), about 26**
2. Oldest signer? — **Benjamin Franklin (PA), 70**
3. Last surviving signer? — **Charles Carroll of Carrollton, d. Nov 14, 1832**
4. Only Roman Catholic signer? — **Charles Carroll of Carrollton**
5. Only active clergyman? — **John Witherspoon (NJ)**
6. Signed all four founding papers? — **Roger Sherman (CT)**
7. Rarest, most valuable autograph? — **Button Gwinnett (GA) — died in a 1777 duel**
8. Name that became a political word? — **Elbridge Gerry -> gerrymandering**

9. Trumbull's painting really shows...? — **The draft being PRESENTED to Congress (~June 28, 1776), not the signing**

Suit III — Myth vs. Fact

1. Franklin's "hang together... hang separately"? — **LEGEND (attributed later, no contemporary record)**
2. "Every signer tortured and died penniless"? — **LEGEND (heavily embellished — real hardship, exaggerated essay)**
3. Hopkins' "My hand trembles, but my heart does not"? — **LEGEND / TRADITION (palsy real, quote undocumented)**
4. Liberty Bell rang for the signing July 4? — **LEGEND (from an 1847 fictional story)**
5. Did the parchment's penman sign it? — **No — generally attributed to Timothy Matlack, not a signer**
6. Passage removed from Jefferson's draft? — **Yes — the slave-trade passage was struck**
7. Committee of Five member who never signed? — **Robert R. Livingston (NY)**

Suit IV — The Human Stories

1. The two signer brothers? — **Richard Henry Lee & Francis Lightfoot Lee (VA)**
2. Rode all night to break his state's tie? — **Caesar Rodney (DE), ~80 miles, arriving July 2**
3. Lost at sea? — **Thomas Lynch Jr. (SC), 1779**
4. "Financier of the Revolution" who hit debtors' prison? — **Robert Morris (PA), 1798-1801**
5. Famous physician-reformer? — **Benjamin Rush (PA) — later reconciled Adams & Jefferson**
6. Georgia's three signers? — **Gwinnett, Hall, Walton**
7. New Hampshire's late signer? — **Matthew Thornton, November 1776**

8. Watched each signer's face (by his own account)? — **William Ellery (RI)**
9. John Hart's farm? — **Really raided in the NJ campaign; the wilder manhunt tales are LEGEND**
10. Average signer age? — **Early-to-mid 40s (range 26 to 70)**

Suit V — The Words & the Artifacts

1. The final pledge? — **"our Lives, our Fortunes and our sacred Honor"**
 2. What went out first — parchment or print? — **Print: ~200 Dunlap broadsides, night of July 4 -> riders July 5**
 3. Dunlap broadsides surviving today? — **26 — one found behind a \$4 painting (1989), sold \$8.14M (2000)**
 4. Silver object from the signing table? — **The Syng inkstand, at Independence Hall**
 5. Franklin's four-document distinction? — **Declaration, Treaty of Alliance, Treaty of Paris, Constitution (commonly cited)**
 6. Why does "July 4" on the parchment confuse people? — **It's the ADOPTION date; most signatures came Aug 2 and later**
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